

Once done, click 'Next'. You will now be taken to a window with the caption "You're almost done...". Here you have a set of options.

Select one of them if your network features operating systems other than Windows XP. If your other systems on the network have Windows XP, then choose the last option and click 'Next', and 'Finish' in the next window. The system will now ask for a reboot. The reboot allows the system to make the necessary changes. Run the Network Setup Wizard on all computers. If the other systems do not have Windows XP as the OS, run the Network Setup Wizard from the Windows XP CD-ROM. You can find the Wizard under 'Perform Additional Tasks', which you can see on the Welcome Menu. If the other system does not have a CD-ROM, then run the Network Setup Wizard from the floppy disk you created. To run the Network Setup Wizard, double-click on the executable file netsetup.exe. XP has now created a LAN using the workgroup name MSHOME.

If you were wondering what happened to those nasty IP addresses, it's time you stopped worrying about it. Your Network Setup Wizard of Windows XP took care of it.

Now to view all the computers on your network, go to Start > My Network Places. If you don't see other computers here, select View Workgroup Computers. You should now be able to see all the computers on the network.

My Network Places allows you to see all the computers on the workgroup which share the same workgroup name-such as the default MSHOME in Windows XP. You should be able to see all the shared folders and printers at this point. If you don't see the shared folders and printers and the network is up, then this is just because that the folders and printers are not shared.